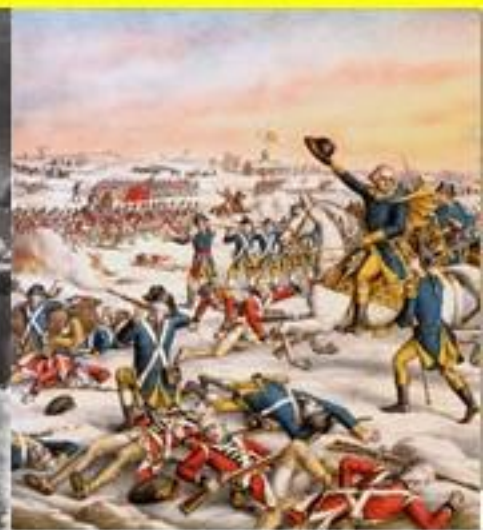


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 3

RENAISSANCE-1

WHAT IS RENAISSANCE?

- 1** The term Renaissance literally means “rebirth” or “revival”.
- 2** This describes the intellectual, political, religious and economic changes that occurred in Europe from 14th century to 17th century.
- 3** The rebirth of classical culture include literature, art, scientific inventions, end of feudalism, emergence of nation-states, spirit of individualism and humanism, global exploration and religious transformation in the Europe is referred to as Renaissance.

- 3** This age is considered as the transition period between the medieval and modern age.



FROM DARKNESS TO LIGHT - THE RENAISSANCE BEGINS

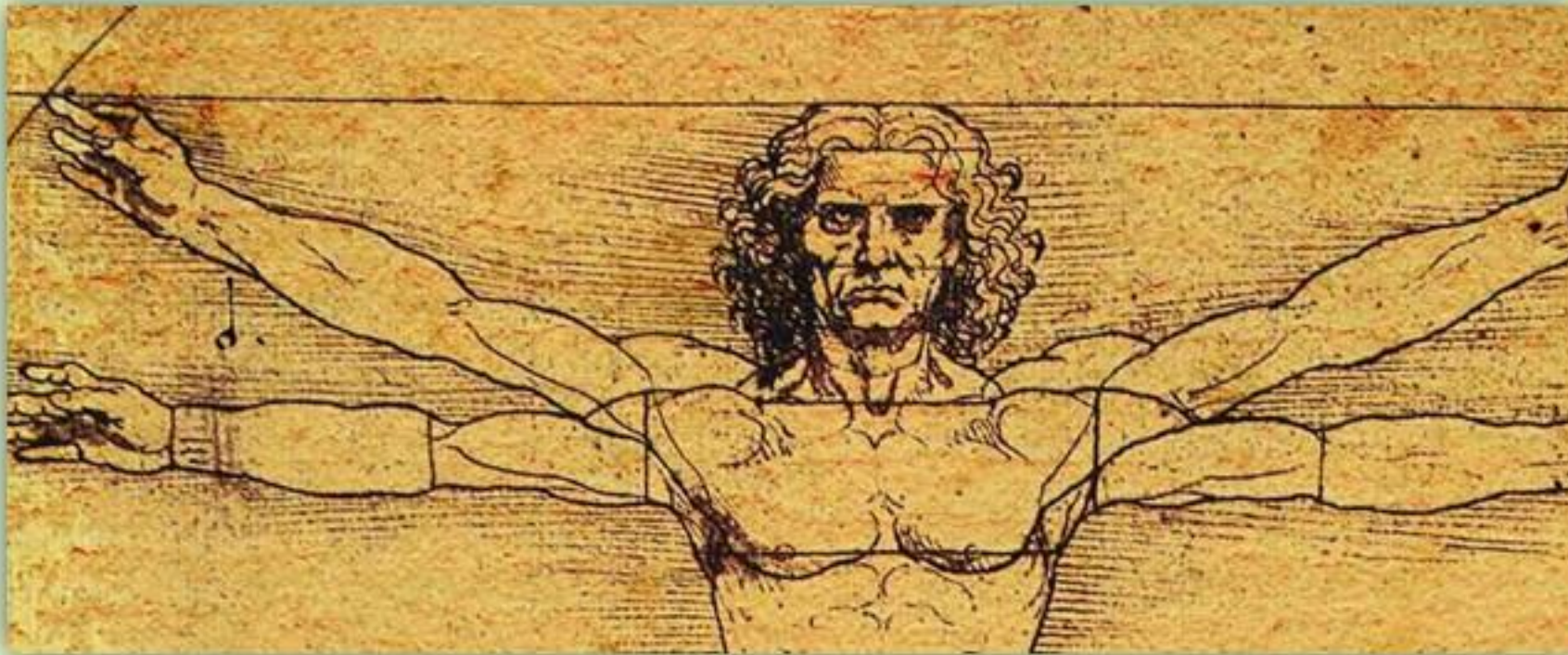
1 During the Middle Ages, a period that took place between the fall of ancient Rome by the end of the 5th century A.D till the capture of Constantinople in 1453 by Ottoman Turks is known as the “Dark Ages” the era is often branded as a time of war, ignorance, famine and pandemics such as the Black Death.

2 It was by the end of this era, Europeans made few advances in science, art, architecture, sculpture, painting, literature, geography and religion.

3 The Byzantine-Greek scholars who fled from Constantinople to Rome revived the Greek and Roman heritage in Italy.



HUMANISM



Humanism promoted the idea that man was the centre of his own universe, and people should embrace human achievements in education, classical arts, literature and science.



WHERE DID RENAISSANCE BEGIN TO TAKE ITS ROOTS?

Italy is considered the birth place of the Renaissance for several reasons. Some of them were:

- ✓ It was the seat of ancient civilization and the Latin language.
- ✓ The rich city states in Italy like Florence and Venice patronized art and literature. For example, the Medici family of Florence had patronized many scholars.
- ✓ The publication of the “Divine Comedy” by the greatest Italian poet Dante (1265-1321) triggered the Renaissance movement in the city of Florence. It was written in the Italian language. Thereafter, the Renaissance spread to other parts of Europe and reached its peak in the sixteenth century.

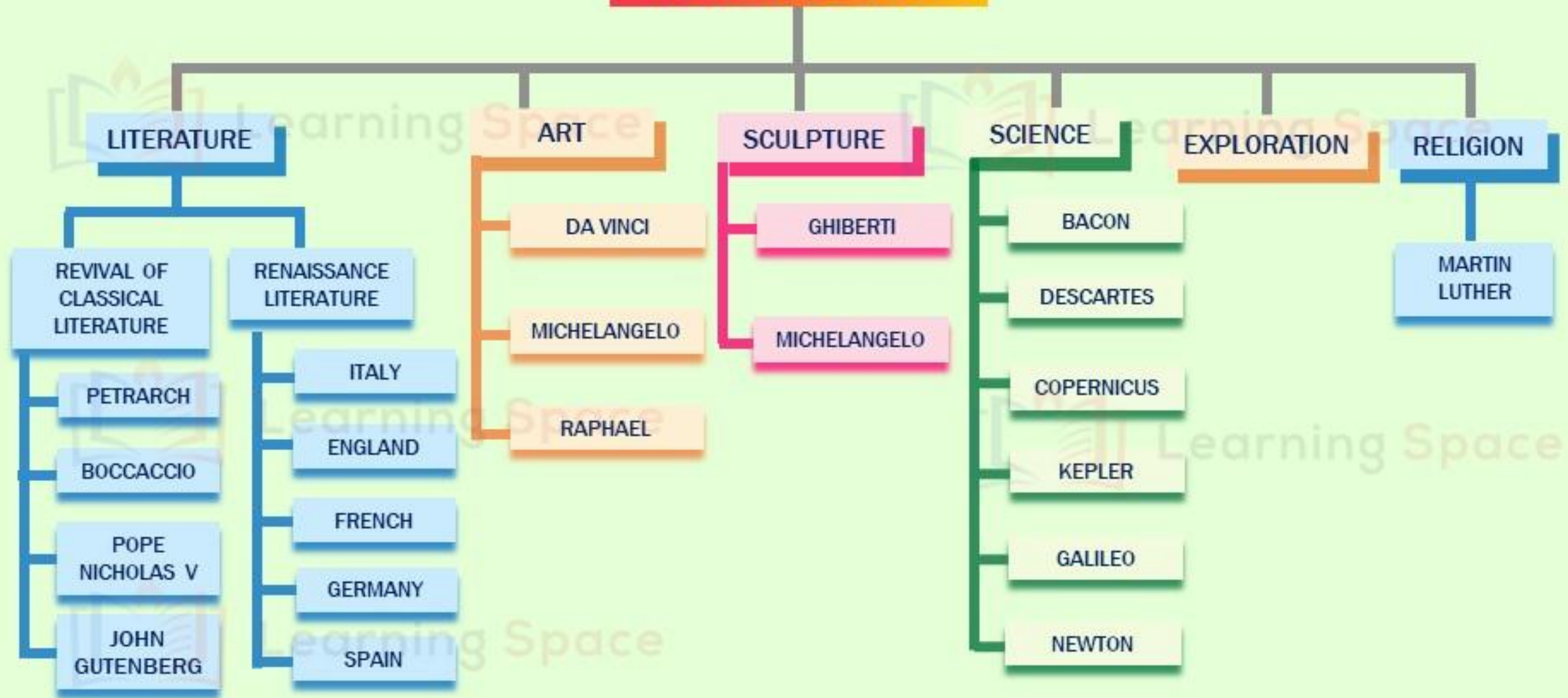


MEDICI FAMILY

- Members of the powerful Medici family, which ruled Florence for more than 60 years, were famous backers of the movement.
- Florence in Italy is a place with a rich cultural history where wealthy citizens could afford to support budding artists.



RENAISSANCE



REVIVAL OF CLASSICAL LITERATURE

The most important contribution of the Renaissance was the revival and learning of ancient Greek and Latin literature. Few of the prominent personalities include:

**PETRARCH**

He is the pioneer in these languages, who collected and compiled many ancient manuscripts containing the works of Plato and Aristotle.

**BOCCACCIO**

He is the disciple of Petrarch, who also encouraged the classical learning.

**MANUEL CHRYSOLORAS**

Many Greek scholars who came from Constantinople spread the ancient Greek literature in Florence. The most notable among them was Manuel Chrysoloras.

REVIVAL OF CLASSICAL LITERATURE

**BRACCIOLINI**

He traced the works of Tacitus, Livy and Sophocles.

**POPE NICHOLAS V**

- In the 15th century he founded the Vatican Library and the ancient manuscripts were preserved in that library.
- They were studied and analysed by scholars.

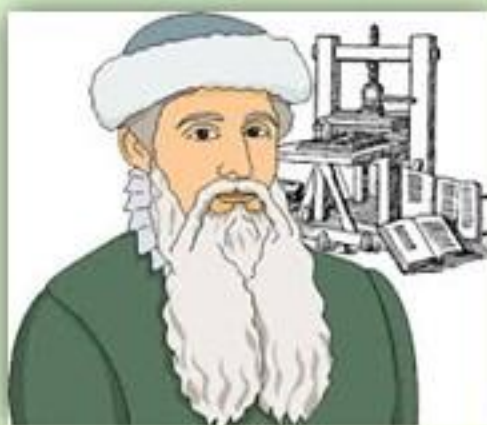
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REVIVAL OF CLASSICAL LITERATURE



ERASMUS

He made a notable contribution in correcting and editing the Latin. He edited the New Testament in the Greek language.



JOHN GUTENBERG

He invented the printing press in Germany and is said to have influenced the Renaissance literature. The first book published by him was The Bible.



WILLIAM CAXTON

He has set up a printing press in England.

- *Shortly, many printing presses came up throughout Europe and it provided a stimulus to the Renaissance movement.*
- *The availability of books at cheaper rates made the masses to improve their awareness.*

RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

- Apart from the revival of classical literature, many works in classical languages as well as in the native languages came up during this period.
- While Italy was the home of the most famous literary figures of the Renaissance, a Renaissance literature typical of that period can also be found in England, France, Germany, and Spain.

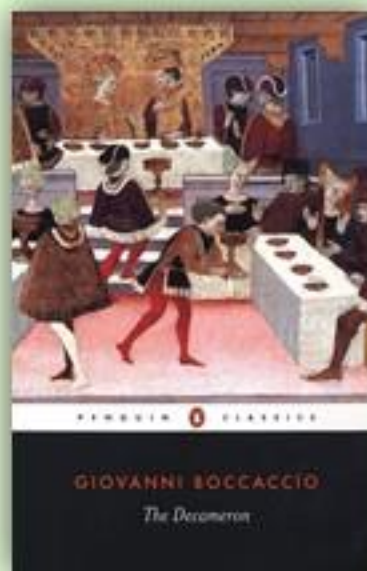


RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

ITALY

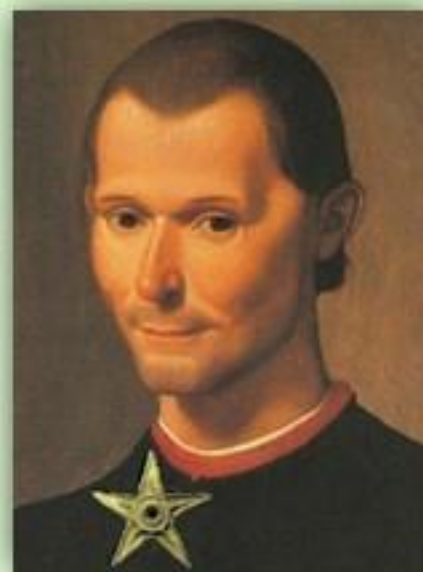
BOCCACCIO

He was the author of the “Decameron”, a collection of fables.



MACHIAVELLI

He lived in Florence, wrote his eight-volume “History of Florence”. His most famous work was “The Prince”, a book on political science.

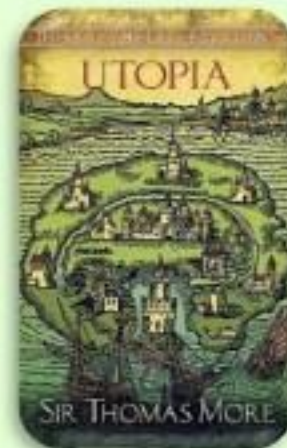


RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

ENGLAND

SIR THOMAS MOORE

- He wrote his famous book Utopia in Latin.
- However, the Elizabethan era marked the beginning of the English Renaissance.
- It saw dramatists like William Shakespeare, Christopher Marlowe and Charles Webster; poets like Edmund Spenser, Sydney and Ben Johnson.



WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

England's "national poet" and the most famous playwright of all time, celebrated for his sonnets and plays like "Romeo and Juliet."



RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

ENGLAND

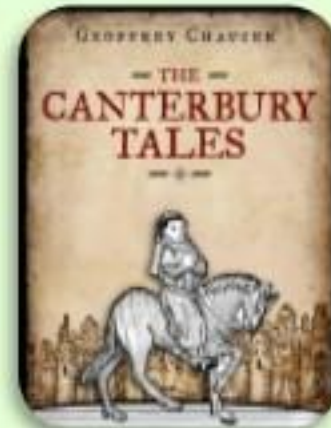
RICHARD HAKLUYT

He wrote excellent travel accounts during this period.



GEOFFREY CHAUCER

He wrote the Canterbury Tales in English

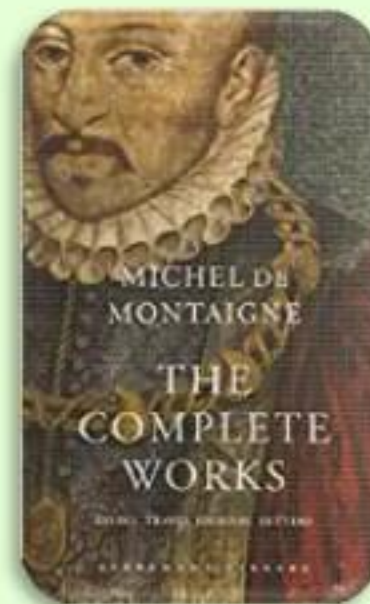


RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

FRENCH

MONTAIGNE

- He is the French essayist, was the most typical writer of the Renaissance literature.
- His works reflect an intense interest in himself and in things connected with the life of man.
- His essays on education were regarded as important for centuries.
- A forerunner of Voltaire in his method of writing and thinking, Montaigne revolted against the authority and the tyranny of the past and earned the title “the first modern man”.



RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

GERMANY

MARTIN LUTHER

He translated "The Bible" in the German language.



SEBASTIAN BRANT

He wrote "The Ship of Fools".



RENAISSANCE LITERATURE

SPAIN

CERVANTES

He authored the famous "Don Quixote".



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